Northwind Collective — IT Equipment & Device Security Policy

Effective 2026. Policy owner: Marcus Chen, IT Operations Lead (marcus.chen@northwind-tech.example).

Equipment Requests

New equipment requests, including laptops, monitors, and docking stations, are submitted through the IT helpdesk portal. Standard requests ship within four business days. Expedited requests, available only for new hires starting within one week, ship within one business day for an additional processing fee of thirty-five dollars.

Device Encryption and Passwords

All company laptops must have full-disk encryption enabled before they leave the IT department. Device passwords must be at least twelve characters and are required to change every ninety days. Biometric unlock may supplement but never replace the password requirement.

Loss or Theft Reporting

A lost or stolen company device must be reported to IT Security within two hours of discovery. IT Security will remotely wipe the device within thirty minutes of a confirmed report. Employees who fail to report within the two-hour window may be held financially responsible for the device's replacement cost.

Bring-Your-Own-Device (BYOD)

Personal devices may be used for email and calendar access only, through the approved mobile management app. Personal devices may never be used to access the engineering source code repositories or the customer database, regardless of VPN status.

Software Installation

Installing new software on a company laptop requires approval from the employee's manager and a security review by IT, except for software on the pre-approved list published on the intranet. Browser extensions are exempt from this requirement but may be removed by IT without notice if found to be a security risk.

Equipment Return

All company equipment must be returned within five business days of an employee's last day. Equipment not returned within thirty days is treated as unreturned company property and may be billed to the employee at its original purchase price.

Warranty and Replacement

Company-issued laptops carry a three-year replacement warranty for hardware failure not caused by user negligence. Accidental damage, such as a cracked screen or liquid spill, is covered once per employee per rolling two-year period; a second incident within that window is billed at fifty percent of replacement cost.

Questions About This Policy

Questions can be directed to the IT helpdesk at helpdesk@northwind-tech.example or through the intranet ticketing system.